



Mark Scheme (Results)

Summer 2026

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE in

English Literature (4ET1)

Paper 1R: Poetry and Modern Prose

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Question Paper Log Number P79512A

Publication Code 4ET1_01R_2606_MS

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

Specific Marking Guidance

When deciding how to reward an answer, examiners should consult both the indicative content and the associated marking grid(s). When using a levels-based mark scheme, the 'best fit' approach should be used.

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level.
- The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- Indicative content is exactly that – they are factual points that candidates are likely to use to construct their answer.
- It is possible for an answer to be constructed without mentioning some or all of these points, as long as they provide alternative responses to the indicative content that fulfils the requirements of the question. It is the examiner's responsibility to apply their professional judgement to the

candidate's response in determining if the answer fulfils the requirements of the question.

Placing a mark within a level

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level. The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- In cases of uneven performance, the points above will still apply. Candidates will be placed in the level that best describes their answer according to the descriptors in that level. Marks will be awarded towards the top or bottom of that level depending on how they have evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points.
- If the candidate's answer meets the requirements fully, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for work that is as good as can realistically be expected within that level.

AO1	Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement.
AO2	Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects.
AO3	Explore links and connections between texts.
AO4	Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written.

Section A – Unseen Poetry

Question number	Indicative content
1	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. It is not sufficient to summarise or paraphrase, nor is it sufficient simply to list literary devices. The writer's descriptive skills: - the writer starts the poem by describing playing a game of hide-and-seek as a child - in the opening stanza, there is a sense of loneliness and isolation amid the joy of playing the game. The writer describes how the last child to say 'Not It' is the one who has to seek the others so is 'left behind / to count down in the dark' - the emphasis on being 'It' in the third stanza marks a shift to a more sinister tone. The feeling of being alone, which is apparent during the game as a child, remains in later life: 'you've always been alone' - the writer describes how, as a child, after counting 'from ten to one', there are others to find. However, as an adult, friends 'can't be found', which highlights how the writer feels completely alone - initially, counting backwards 'from ten to one' builds up to the excitement of playing the game of hide-and-seek. However, later in the poem, the writer describes how they 'can't stop counting down / from ten to one', perhaps indicative of how they are constantly yearning for their youth and being part of a friendship group - the last stanza could be indicative of how the writer is no longer alone because the clothes 'fit' and they are 'Not It' - alternatively, it could be argued that the end of the poem reflects a desire for time to be reversed. The usual order of the hyphenated compound phrases said before a game of hide-and-seek is switched, as if the poet wants to rewind their life to a time spent with friends: 'from Here-I-Come to Ready-or-Not' - candidates are free to interpret the poem how they choose. All interpretations, if supported with valid evidence, should be rewarded. The writer's choice of language: - the title and opening exclamation, 'Not It!', conveys the initial excitement of playing the game with friends - hyphenated compound phrases, all commonly used in children's games, allude to the innocence of taking part in the game: 'Ready-or-Not', 'Here-I-Come'. They mark the period of being alone before friends are found as part of the game - the lexical field of darkness contributes to an increasingly sinister tone as the poem progresses: 'dark', 'covered eyes', 'day turns night' and, later, 'night turns day'. All allude to a feeling of loneliness and being alone

- the repetition of 'day turns night' is indicative of the progression of time, as the child becomes an adult, and the constant repetition throughout the poem highlights just how quickly life seems to pass the writer by
- the writer uses repetition again to highlight that, as they grow older, 'the game's gone on and on'; there is no escaping the loneliness of being 'It'
- the writer uses the double negative 'not not', with echoes of distress, to mark how the child has grown older: 'you're not not the one / in grown-up clothes that don't quite fit'. The fact that the 'grown-up clothes don't quite fit' suggests that the writer feels isolated and out of place as they grow up
- being in 'grown-up clothes that finally fit' could represent how the writer, as an adult, no longer feels alone and out of place in the world
- alternatively, the shift at the end of the poem, to being in 'grown-up clothes that finally fit', could be considered a moment of no return for the writer; they will be stuck in the loneliness of adulthood for perpetuity, yet they are still yearning for the fun and companionship of the game, and their youth, as they shout 'Not It! Not It!'
- as noted above, candidates are free to interpret the poem how they choose. All interpretations, if supported with valid evidence, should be rewarded.

The writer's use of form and structure:

- the thirty-two-line poem consists of one long sentence, perhaps reflective of how there is no stopping the inevitability of being alone when growing up
- the enjambement throughout the poem increases the pace. Initially, it could mimic the pace of the game but, as the poem progresses, it could indicate how life passes by quickly
- later in the poem, there is a suggestion that the writer wants to be back playing the game with friends, 'running out / of breath', they are still 'counting backward'
- the last stanza sums up the shift from being alone as a child to being comfortable as an adult, 'in grown-up clothes that finally fit'
- the poem starts and finishes with the same phrase, 'Not It!', but at the end this is repeated: 'Not It! Not It!' The end of the poem could represent the writer's relief at being 'Not It' and no longer feeling alone.

These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.

Level	Mark	AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–4	- The response is simple and the identification of language, form and structure used by the writer is minimal. - Limited use of relevant examples to support the response.
Level 2	5–8	- The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. - Some use of relevant examples to support the response.
Level 3	9–12	- The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. - Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	13–16	- The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. - Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	17–20	- The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. - Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Section B – Anthology Poetry

Question number	Indicative content
2	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on comparison of the two poems. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. It is not sufficient to summarise or paraphrase, nor is it sufficient simply to list literary devices. Sonnet 116 (AO2) Responses may include: • Shakespeare conveys his thoughts, as a man, about a loving relationship and the meaning of true love. The reference to the 'marriage of true minds' suggests that he believes that a loving relationship is lasting and never changes: 'Love alters not' • the sonnet begins with a reminder of the traditional vows made at a Christian marriage, referring to 'impediments'. Shakespeare believes that a loving relationship will not 'Admit impediments' • Shakespeare's views on relationships and the durability of true love are emphasised through repeated words: 'love is not love / Which alters when it alteration finds, / Or bends with the remover to remove' • it is suggested in a metaphor that Shakespeare believes that love is a guide in a loving relationship and love is as precious and constant as 'an ever-fixed mark', the 'star to every wandering bark' • Shakespeare suggests that true love can survive any storms or difficulties in a relationship: 'That looks on tempests and is never shaken' • again, the durability of love in a relationship is illustrated with the metaphor 'not Time's fool', showing that Shakespeare believes that a loving relationship is not limited or tricked by time, even though looks may have changed as the end of life approaches • the 'sickle's compass' is linked to the idea of death and the image of the Grim Reaper. Shakespeare believes that true love does not change, even as people fall ill or get old • furthermore, it is Shakespeare's belief that love will last even in extremes, 'even to the edge of doom' • the conventional Shakespearean sonnet structure ends with the rhyming couplet in which Shakespeare offers a challenge to his readers, saying that, if his thoughts about love are wrong and love is not enduring, then he has 'never writ, nor no man ever loved'. La Belle Dame sans Merci (AO2) Responses may include: • the poem focuses on the plight of a knight, who becomes obsessed with, and abandoned by, an enchantress. It begins with the knight's lonely situation: 'Alone and pearly loitering', which is repeated at the end, showing how he is deeply affected by the woman • the opening three stanzas of this narrative poem are the words of an unknown narrator questioning the knight with concern at his state, which is 'So haggard

	and so woe-begone'. This description suggests that the knight is left devastated as a result of being abandoned by the woman • La Belle Dame is presented as a 'faery's child' who affects the knight by entrancing, bewitching and entrapping him with her beauty and supernatural powers. The knight becomes obsessed with the woman • colour imagery is used to describe the dramatic effect that his meeting with, and subsequent desertion by, the lady has had on the knight: his pale skin is described with the symbolic metaphor 'lily on thy brow'. This shows how the knight's love for the woman has emotionally and physically drained him • pathetic fallacy also reflects how the knight is affected by the faery. The 'garland' and 'roots of relish sweet, / And honey wild' are replaced by 'the sedge has withered' and 'no birds sing' • the faery is described as 'light' of 'foot'. She has long hair and 'wild eyes', repeated later as 'wild wild eyes'. This repetition of 'wild' emphasises her effect on the knight and how he is taken by her physical features, suggesting that, for him, love is based on appearances • she leads the knight to believe that she loves him, 'I love thee true', but her feelings appear to be false when she abandons him. She is presented as being a Circe-like figure: an enchantress who attracts lovers to destroy them. The faery affects the knight by causing him to suffer pain and anguish • in the knight's dream he is warned that he has been enslaved by a cruel lady; when he awakes, he finds himself alone on the hill. He experiences the pains of what is, for him perhaps, true love • archaic language enhances the medieval setting and the supernatural charms of the bewitcher: 'steed', 'faery', 'grot', 'meads', 'sojourn' • repetition is used to engage the reader; the final stanza echoes the first, but with some variation, perhaps stressing the fate of the knight and linking him to the ghastly line of other suitors who have been bewitched by the woman. The use of repeated questions and archaic language is typical of the ballad form • the ballad rhymes the second and fourth lines of each stanza. This, together with the shorter last line of each verse, increases the narrative flow of the poem. Both poems Both poems have particular merits and features and therefore there are a number of points of comparison which candidates will make. Examiners might consider the following areas of comparison where applicable: treatment of subject matter and theme, tone, voice, attitude, character, diction, imagery including figurative language, poetic form/structure including rhythm, line length, enjambement. All points of comparison should be developed and supported by close reference and evaluation of specific examples. (AO3) Responses may include: • <i>Sonnet 116</i> is a classic Shakespearean sonnet, whereas <i>La Belle Dame sans Merci</i> is written in 12 four-line stanzas, each with regular rhythm and rhyming pattern
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| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• both poems consider the struggles of love from a man's point of view. One poem considers how true love can survive difficulties, while the other poem reflects on the problems of unrequited love• there is just one speaker in <i>Sonnet 116</i>, providing a personal account of love, whereas <i>La Belle Dame sans Merci</i> is in the form of dialogue between two speakers, which facilitates the knight's sharing his experiences of the faery woman• both poems view love as unalterable. Even though the knight in <i>La Belle Dame sans Merci</i> has been abandoned by his lover, he still loves her. |
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These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.

Level	Mark	AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks) AO3 Explore links and connections between texts. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• The response is simple and the identification of language, form and structure used by the writer is minimal. • There is little or no comparison of the two poems. • Limited use of relevant examples to support the response.
Level 2	7–12	• The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. • There are some underdeveloped comparisons and contrasts presented, with obvious similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Some use of relevant examples to support the response. NB: the mark awarded cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2 if only ONE poem has been considered.
Level 3	13–18	• The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. • The response compares and contrasts a range of points and considers some similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	19–24	• The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. • The response compares and contrasts the poems effectively, considering a wide range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	25–30	• The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. • The response compares and contrasts the poems perceptively with a varied and comprehensive range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Question number	Indicative content
3	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on comparison of the two poems. Indicative content is offered for <i>Blessing</i> but because candidates are asked to choose any other appropriate poem from the selection, it is not possible to indicate content for the second except in generic ways. <i>Blessing</i> (AO2) Responses may include: • positive feelings are felt by the community when a municipal water pipe bursts in an area that has little water because of drought. The water supply is seen as a godly gift. The event, which would normally be a problem, brings wonderment and relief to the community • the poem opens with a powerful simile emphasising the experiences and discomfort of everyday life in severe heat when 'The skin cracks like a pod' and 'There never is enough water'. A vivid picture is then created of the dramatic and euphoric reactions of the crowds, especially the children, when the water pipe bursts • the writer contrasts the imaginary picture of a longed-for drip of water, 'the small splash', with the 'blessing' of the torrent of water that 'crashes to the ground' from the burst pipe • the water's value is conveyed by using precious-metal imagery: 'silver crashes to the ground' • positive feelings are conveyed through striking images of the moment the water breaks free: 'the flow has found / a roar of tongues'. The excitement of the experience is heightened with the desperate collection by everyone of all sorts of containers to hold the water: 'pots', 'plastic buckets', 'frantic hands' • the onomatopoeic words, 'bursts', 'crashes' and 'roar', convey images of the event and the experience as it occurs • a sense of wonder is created with the use of alliteration: 'polished to perfection', describing the skin of children glistening as they frolic under the water • religious imagery is used throughout the poem; the experience is a 'blessing'. Other symbolic references are made: 'a kindly god', 'a congregation', 'the blessing sings' • the structure of the poem moves from short statements, beginning with a two-lined stanza of two separate sentences: 'The skin cracks like a pod. / There never is enough water', through imagining a small drip and on to images of gushing water and the euphoria of the people. These 'drips' of information become more fluid, with the use of commas, as the water flows freely. The second half of the poem is one long sentence, and the poem builds towards a climax of dramatic movement and sound. <i>Blessing and one other poem</i> Both poems have particular merits and features and therefore there are a number of points of comparison which candidates will make. Examiners might consider

the following areas of comparison where applicable: treatment of subject matter and theme, tone, voice, attitude, character, diction, imagery including figurative language, poetic form/structure including rhythm, line length, enjambement.

All points of comparison should be developed and supported by close reference and evaluation of specific examples.

(AO3) Responses may include:

- the poem chosen must be one in which positive feelings feature, such as *Piano*, *Sonnet 116*, *Poem at Thirty-Nine*, *The Tyger*, *Remember*, or any other appropriate poem from the collection
- the similarities and differences of subject matter in each poem will be considered
- comparative links made between techniques, such as specific comparisons made in relation to language, and supporting these points with relevant evidence from the two poems, will be evident
- comparisons and comments will be made on the use of form and structure
- comparisons of how the two poems affect the reader may be considered.

These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.

Level	Mark	AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks) AO3 Explore links and connections between texts. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• The response is simple and the identification of language, form and structure used by the writer is minimal. • There is little or no comparison of the two poems. • Limited use of relevant examples to support the response.
Level 2	7–12	• The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. • There are some underdeveloped comparisons and contrasts presented, with obvious similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Some use of relevant examples to support the response. NB: the mark awarded cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2 if only ONE poem has been considered.
Level 3	13–18	• The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. • The response compares and contrasts a range of points and considers some similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	19–24	• The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. • The response compares and contrasts the poems effectively, considering a wide range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	25–30	• The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. • The response compares and contrasts the poems perceptively with a varied and comprehensive range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Section C – Modern Prose

Question number	Indicative content
4 <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Tom Robinson is presented as a mockingbird character in the novel: he is a good person who does no harm to others. Society's treatment of him serves to illustrate the racial and social injustices of the time • Tom is a twenty-five-year-old African American, happily married to Helen, and they have three children. Tom's left arm is crippled because, as a child, his arm was caught in a cotton gin. Tom is presented as hardworking and resilient because he does not let his injury prevent him from working • he is presented as a kind character in his treatment of Mayella Ewell. Tom passes by the Ewells' cabin regularly on his way to work, befriends and feels sorry for the lonely and poverty-stricken Mayella, even though she is white • despite Tom's disability, he is willing to help Mayella, when she asks him to get a box down from the chiffarobe, but she tries to kiss him. When Bob Ewell catches her in this situation, she feels she has to blame Tom rather than take responsibility for her actions • Tom illustrates the desperate position of an African-American man accused of rape by a white woman. The events surrounding his arrest and conviction highlight the issues of racism and injustice • Atticus Finch agrees to defend Tom in court, despite knowing the battle is lost before it begins. Atticus knows that Mayella's accusations are untenable owing to Tom's disability, but the white judge and jury will ignore this convincing evidence in the face of the greater weight of racial prejudice and the word of a white girl. In his summing up at the end of the trial, Atticus notes that Tom's only guilt lies in his having the temerity to feel pity for a white girl, however poor and despised her family is. The fact that Tom is convicted of rape, despite the overwhelming evidence to the contrary, presents him as a victim of injustice • Tom is presented as a mockingbird character: it is a sin to kill one as it never does any harm to anyone. The reader sees Tom's gentle character when he speaks to Atticus, who has just protected him from the lynch mob: 'A soft, husky voice came from the darkness above: "Are they gone?"' • it could be argued that Tom is presented as courageous when he tries to escape from prison. He is caught and killed 'in cold blood'. Atticus points out, 'I guess Tom was tired of taking white man's chances and preferred to take his own' • ultimately, Tom is presented as a symbol of hope for the future. His trial allows Scout and Jem to understand the society they live in, and it makes some people in Maycomb consider the injustice of his trial. (AO4)

	• Tom's trial could have been informed by the Scottsboro trials of 1931–1937. Nine black men were accused of raping two white women on a train. After lengthy trials, the men were all given long prison sentences, even though lawyers rightly argued the accusations were false. Just like Tom, the Scottsboro Boys endured lynch mobs and a biased, all-white jury • hatred by many white people for the black community was extreme, especially during the Great Depression when money was scarce. Tom's treatment as a victim epitomises Maycomb's racist attitudes • Atticus refers to racism as Maycomb County's 'disease'. The newspaper report shows signs of progress by acknowledging the 'injustice' of the case. The treatment of the mockingbird characters, such as Tom, demonstrates the injustices of the time • Tom's trial serves to educate Scout. The novel is of the bildungsroman genre: Scout learns lessons and begins to mature.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
5 <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Harper Lee explores the theme of bravery through the actions of a variety of characters, including Atticus, Jem, Scout, Boo Radley, Mrs Dubose and Tom Robinson • Atticus demonstrates bravery when he represents Tom during his trial. Atticus makes a stand against racial prejudice and the views held by the residents of Maycomb, even though he knows it will cause him and his family some difficulties. Atticus also shows bravery when he keeps guard outside the jail following Tom's guilty verdict • as Jem matures, he learns the true meaning of bravery. At the beginning of the novel, Scout says that he 'never declined a dare' and was brave to touch the Radley house. As events unfold, he learns what real bravery is when he observes his father shoot the rabid dog, Tim Johnson, and when he is told about Mrs Dubose fighting her morphine addiction • both Jem and Scout show bravery by standing up to the lynch mob and refusing to leave when ordered to by Atticus. Scout defuses the anger of the mob by addressing Mr Cunningham directly, which reduces the mob mentality by her talking with him • Boo Radley demonstrates bravery when he ventures from the security of his house and saves Jem and Scout from Bob Ewell when they are walking home on Halloween. Bob Ewell is said to have died by his own knife after Boo intervenes to save the children from him • Mrs Dubose is brave when she battles with her morphine addiction so that she can be free of her addiction before she dies. Atticus uses the opportunity to teach Jem and Scout what 'real courage' is. He tells them about her morphine addiction and concludes by saying that she is the 'bravest person I ever knew' • Tom, perhaps, demonstrates bravery when he tries to escape from jail. He is caught and killed 'in cold blood'. Atticus points out, 'I guess Tom was tired of taking white man's chances and preferred to take his own' • following Tom's trial, Mr Underwood is brave when he writes the editorial for The Maycomb Tribune. He likens Tom's death to the 'senseless slaughter of songbirds', which serves to highlight Tom's innocence and unjust treatment • Chuck Little, Scout's classmate, shows bravery when he stands up to Burris Ewell in defence of his teacher, Miss Caroline. Scout describes how Chuck 'was born a gentleman'. When Burris threatens Miss Caroline, Chuck tells Burris 'Watch your step ... I'd soon's kill you as look at you' • Dill, a friend of Scout and Jem from Mississippi, shows bravery when he runs away from home and returns to Maycomb. He is unhappy at home because his mother and his new stepfather exclude him. Dill says that they 'do get on a lot better without me. I cannot help them any'. (AO4)

	• Atticus refers to Maycomb County's 'disease' when discussing racism. Tom's trial represents the unfairness and racism in places such as Maycomb during the 1930s • in defending Tom, Atticus shows bravery by going against the social mores of Maycomb County. Atticus, a white lawyer, gives the reader some hope that justice might be done and that times might be changing; he takes the case as a matter of conscience, despite the prejudice around him and despite the threats made to both his children and himself • Boo Radley's bravery challenges society's perception of him as a recluse, about whom wild stories have grown up • the newspaper report shows signs of progress by voicing the injustice of society and mirrors Lee's views at a time when the Civil Rights Movement was gaining momentum.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
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Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
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Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
6 <i>Of Mice and Men</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • violence is significant in the novel because it is an inherent part of life on the ranch. The violent actions of Lennie, in particular, result in the spiralling events in the novel • George protects Lennie throughout the novel, and, to do so, he sometimes has to resort to violence in order to control him. He confesses to Slim about the time he had to hit Lennie with a 'fence picket' • Candy's dog suffers a violent death. When Carlson pushes for the dog to be shot, Candy protests: 'Well – hell! I had him so long'. Eventually, once Slim has agreed, Carlson leads the dog outside to shoot him in the back of the head. When the shot rings out, Candy turns miserably to face the wall. Candy tells George that he should have shot his dog himself, which is significant because it foreshadows George's decision to end Lennie's life at the end of the novel • Curley's wife's use of vicious language, when she threatens Crooks with hanging, is significant because it shows her frustration and loneliness at being the only female on the ranch. She tells him: 'I could get you strung up on a tree so easy it ain't even funny'. Crooks knows that the threat is real and is crushed by it: 'Crooks had reduced himself to nothing ... "Yes, ma'am," and his voice was toneless'. This is important because, from Crooks' perspective, it extinguishes any hope he has of joining the dream of George, Lennie and Candy, even though the other men take his side against that of Curley's wife. It shows the vulnerability of black people to any accusation by a white person • Curley demonstrates aggression when he picks on and fights Lennie. He is a bully and is able to bully others because of his position as the boss's son. The significance of this is that it demonstrates the hierarchy of the ranch • Lennie is unaware of his own strength, as shown when he accidentally crushes the mice. Lennie is also violent when he gets frustrated or frightened, for example when he crushes Curley's hand. This is significant because it foreshadows his actions later in the novel, culminating in killing his pup and then killing Curley's wife • the death of Curley's wife is sudden and violent. Lennie is again unaware of his own strength and seems unsure whether she is dead, continuing to talk to her after he has accidentally broken her neck • after the death of Curley's wife, Curley gathers the men together to pursue Lennie. Curley's response to the death of his wife reflects his lack of true feeling for her. He is far more interested in getting a posse together and lynching Lennie than suffering any kind of upset at the loss of his wife • at the end of the novel, George has to take a violent step to protect Lennie from Curley, who has threatened to shoot Lennie in 'the guts'. Instead of suffering a harsher death at the hands of Curley, Lennie dies thinking about the dream

- the violence in nature, such as when the heron plucks out the water snake, is significant because it is symbolic of the human violence at the end of the novel.

(AO4)

- the unsettled lives of itinerant workers contribute to their feelings of violence and unrest
- characters are intimidated by Curley's body language and his boxing prowess, but they can do nothing about this as they could be 'canned'; they are migrant workers in an economically unstable time
- there was no social care for people such as Lennie who could have been put in the 'booby hatch', where it is likely he would have been treated violently
- many characters' beliefs in the American Dream are destroyed by violence.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
7 <i>Of Mice and Men</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • George is presented as a caring character in the novel in a number of ways. He has taken care of Lennie since Lennie's Aunt Clara died. George's role in looking after Lennie is important because Lennie has learning difficulties, which means that he is vulnerable • George's role as Lennie's protector and carer is established at the beginning of the novel. Lennie walks behind George, as George always goes first: 'one stayed behind the other'. The reader learns that the two men are on the run, having escaped from Weed, because Lennie got into trouble for holding on to a woman's dress after wanting to feel the soft fabric • it becomes apparent early in the novel that George cares for Lennie's wellbeing. George prevents Lennie drinking the stagnant water and he takes the dead mice away from Lennie • the two men share the dream of living 'off the fatta the lan' '. When Lennie repeatedly asks George to tell him about their plans, George shows he cares for Lennie by focusing on the animals, the part that Lennie is most excited about: 'we'll have a big vegetable patch and a rabbit hutch and chickens' • fully aware of the fact that Lennie gets himself into trouble, George cares for Lennie by planning ahead. George tells Lennie to 'hide in the brush' if he should need to run away from the ranch • George insists on looking after Lennie's work card for him and does all the talking when they meet the boss of the ranch. The boss is suspicious of George's motives for travelling with Lennie: 'what stake you got in this guy? You taking his pay away from him?' George tells the lie that Lennie is his cousin and says that he was kicked in the head by a horse when he was a child. It is probable that George takes and looks after Lennie's wages, as he does every other aspect of Lennie's life, but it could be argued that this is to protect Lennie rather than being done for George's personal gain • Lennie relies on George for protection: 'Jesus Christ, somebody'd shoot you for a coyote if you was by yourself'. He warns him to stay away from both Curley and his wife, explaining that both are likely to bring trouble. When Curley attacks Lennie, it is George who tells him to fight back • later, Lennie is pursued by Curley and his posse, who are intent on lynching him in revenge for his killing Curley's wife. George's previous caring act of telling Lennie where to go if he gets into trouble means that Lennie knows to hide in the brush. Lennie is, therefore, able to evade Curley's ire • George's shooting of Lennie at the end of the novel is, arguably, testament to how much George cares for his friend. Instead of suffering a harsher death at the hands of Curley, Lennie dies thinking about the dream. It could be considered that, because of George, Lennie is the only character almost to see his dream come true. (AO4)

	• at the time of the Great Depression, itinerant farm workers tended to travel alone. It was survival of the fittest and perhaps some itinerant farm labourers had to be selfish in order to survive and gain jobs. It was unusual for men to travel as a pair • Lennie relies on George to care for him. There was little or no provision of social care. Without George, Lennie would most likely have been put in a 'booby hatch' and, as Crooks taunts, he would be kept like a dog: 'They'll tie ya up with a collar' • the American Dream gave hope for all those whose goal was to gain some form of independence. It could be argued that, without George, Lennie would not have any hope at all to achieve this.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
8 The Whale Rider	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Koro Apirana could be considered the most important character in the novel. He is the head of the male-dominated Maori community and guardian of Maori customs, language and beliefs of the time. Throughout the novel, Koro desperately seeks to secure the Maori traditions and culture for future generations • it could be argued that Koro is the most important character because much of the novel focuses on his journey of acceptance of a female heir as tribal leader. Initially, Koro rejects great-granddaughter, Kahu. He is disappointed and ‘won’t have anything to do with her’. He cannot ‘reconcile his traditional beliefs about Maori leadership and rights with Kahu’s birth’. Koro hopes that Porourangi will ‘have a son next time’ • Koro is upset that his great-granddaughter, Kahu, is named after Kahutia Te Rangī, the ancestral leader. He believes this should be a male heir’s name and he refuses to take part in the custom of burying Kahu’s afterbirth, so Nanny (Nani) Flowers arranges this herself. Nanny looks after Kahu and spends much of her time trying to persuade her husband to accept her • Koro teaches the boys about tribal traditions and history, and establishes language nests, <i>Kohanga Reo</i>. Maori legends are passed down from generation to generation. The tribe believes in the legend of their ancestor, Kahutia Te Rangī, or Paīkea, who escaped drowning by riding on the back of a whale to safety. Importantly for Koro, it is believed that if the spiritually tattooed or marked bull whale should die, then the tribe will die along with it: ‘When it dies, we die. I die’ • despite Kahu’s idolisation and adoration of Koro, he still rejects her. Kahu does everything in her power to learn her tribal history, customs and language in order to make her great-grandfather proud of her, which is evidence of Koro’s importance • Nanny attempts to make her husband appreciate Kahu, but Koro stubbornly refuses to attend Kahu’s end-of-school ceremony and her talk about him. Kahu has learned the family’s <i>whakapapa</i> and recites it in Maori language • Koro spends time with his grandson, Porourangi, preparing him as his successor. They travel to Raukawa to see how the Maoris there are preparing the youth for the future • in his quest to find a male heir for Kahu’s generation, Koro sets a challenge for the boys to recover a stone that he has thrown to the bottom of the sea. When none of them succeed, he shuts himself away and weeps • Koro’s importance is evident when Kahu dives to retrieve the stone, as she wants to prove herself to him. Wisely, Nanny keeps the stone until she can use it in Kahu’s favour. When Kahu climbs onto the bull whale’s back, Nanny gives the stone to Koro to prove Kahu’s worthy place as tribal leader, despite being female

- after Kahu rides the bull whale and saves the herd, the family realises that she could have died. Koro learns to appreciate that Kahu is a natural leader. Koro admits that he has made a mistake in rejecting Kahu, and tells her 'Boy or girl, it doesn't matter ... I love you'.

(AO4)

- Koro is the epitome of a male-dominated Maori society at the time the novel is set
- he is the guardian of Maori customs, language and beliefs and is a part of a wider movement to support Maori heritage and land rites
- the legend of Kahutia Te Rangi (Paikea) and Koro's desire and obsession for a patrilineal descendant determine his treatment of Kahu and the reactions of his wife
- Koro is closely associated with the relationship between man and the natural world, particularly the whales, and laments the betrayal of the whales by Man
- he comes to understand that salvation can be embodied in the female form and that his bloodline and ancestry must disregard assumptions about male superiority.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
9 The Whale Rider	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the theme of fear is prominent throughout the novel, including fear for the future survival of Maori traditions and culture, and fear for the future survival of the whales - in Spring, the first part of the novel, the bull whale leads the herd away from human predators. Although the female whales care for and love the bull whale, they are afraid that he will lead them into danger: 'their leader was turning his thoughts to the dangerous islands to the south-west' - the bull whale fears the whales' biggest predator: mankind. He fears the loss of the herd through Man's destruction of the planet. He leads the herd through the frozen waters of Antarctica and the collapsing ice-shelves - Koro is afraid that, without a male heir for Kahu's generation, the Maori tribe in Whangara will not survive. Fearing that Maori customs and traditions are being lost, he establishes a Maori language class, or <i>Kohanga Reo</i>. When Koro asks the boys to retrieve a stone from the seabed to test their leadership qualities, none of the boys is able to do so - Nanny (Nani) Flowers fears her husband's views are outdated and makes comparisons between Koro's treatment of Kahu and racism, suggesting that his treatment of Kahu is unacceptable. Nanny calls Koro's <i>wananga</i> sessions with the men 'the Ku Klux Klan' and she tells Koro 'Girls can do anything these days' - Kahu fears rejection by her great-grandfather. Koro will not accept Kahu as a tribal leader and Kahu's love for him is unrequited. She fears that her great-grandfather will not attend the school ceremony. When the reserved seat for Koro remains empty, his absence reduces her to tears - the people of Whangara are afraid when two hundred whales beach themselves. The news reporter says that it 'is like seeing the end of the world'. Despite people's efforts, the entire herd perishes. Following the loss of the herd, another large group of whales emerges and becomes beached, including the bull whale that has symbolic markings on it - Koro is afraid that the possible beaching of the bull whale would suggest that the spirit of their ancestor, Kahutia Te Rangi, wants to die. Fears for the future are conveyed by Koro who explains 'When it dies, we die, I die', but hopefully, if it lives 'we live also' - Koro fears that the 'partnership' between humans and the natural world ended when commercial hunters began killing the whales and he worries about a future life without 'oneness'. Rawiri recalls former times when the natural world was at 'oneness' with humans, a time of 'helpful partnership' - Nanny, Koro and the family fear for Kahu's life when she rides the bull whale and is taken out to sea. Nanny collapses in fear and shock. Kahu is returned to her people and is found unconscious on the beach. She is taken to hospital and her anxious

family keeps vigil by her bedside. Koro is so afraid that she will die that he 'asked the Gods to forgive him'.

(AO4)

- when the whales beach themselves, conservationists and environmental groups come to help with the rescue attempts: 'Greenpeace, Project Jonah and Friends of the Earth'. *Greenpeace* is a non-political environmental organisation established in 1971 with offices all over the world. Its head office is in Amsterdam. *Project Jonah* was established in 1974 in New Zealand to protect and conserve marine mammals. *Friends of the Earth* was established in America in 1969 and is an international network of 74 countries dedicated to environmental concerns
- *The Whale Rider* was published in 1987, during a time when the testing of nuclear arms was prevalent and nuclear test sites were very much a concern. In the novel, the whale herd mourns the death of some calves following nuclear testing at Moruroa. In 1985, the *Greenpeace* ship, *Rainbow Warrior*, protesting about nuclear testing, was sunk in Auckland harbour
- Whangara is a small Maori community in the northeast of New Zealand's North Island. In 1961, the Whangara *Kapa Haka* Group was formed; the elders support the group in keeping customs and traditions alive
- Koro's fears are guided by Maori traditions and culture; his desire for a male heir to succeed him leads him to ignore Kahu's qualities and her love for him.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
10 <i>The Joy Luck Club</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • there are many examples of courage being shown throughout the novel, including how Lindo Jong escaped an unhappy marriage and fled to America • courage is shown through Suyuan Woo. She set up the Joy Luck Club in China to help shield the women from the harshness of war. The club continues in San Francisco, where the women immigrate, facilitating the opportunity for them to share stories and memories of their lives in China, and providing them with a sense of order and belonging • when Suyuan fled war-torn China, she was forced to abandon her twin daughters, Chwun Yu and Chwun Hwa. Suyuan's journey was arduous, and she is left full of grief for her lost daughters. At first, Suyuan does not tell her daughter, Jing-mei, the full story of her past life in China, which results in Jing-mei's lack of empathy for her • courage is shown when Jing-mei accepts the challenge of going to China to find her lost sisters after her mother's death. Despite her concerns about the trip, she embraces the opportunity to explore her Chinese heritage. As the narrator, Jing-mei creates bridges between American and Chinese cultures, and the other mothers and their daughters • another example of courage is how Lindo managed to free herself from her loveless marriage and the oppression of her tyrannical mother-in-law, Huang Taitai. Lindo played on her mother-in-law's superstitions when she told her about the double-ended candle going out. Lindo claimed that it went out in a dream, but that was enough to persuade her mother-in-law that the marriage was doomed • Waverly Jong is courageous as she inherits her mother's 'invisible strength'. She hides her emotions and strategises her ideas. She is humiliated by Jing-mei at Suyuan's New Year's dinner because of the rivalry between them. She worries that her mother does not like her fiancé, Rich Shields, but does not let that separate them • An-mei Hsu has had to show courage to overcome the difficulties in her life. Her mother took her own life, and she was badly treated by her grandmother, Popo, until she went to live with her stepfather. Her youngest child, Bing, dies in an accident. As a result of her experiences in life, she is forced to become stoical and to conceal her pain and tears • courage is demonstrated by Rose Hsu Jordan in her resilience. She has carried the guilt of her brother's death, although it is not her fault. She has been asked for a divorce by her husband, Ted, who has been a domineering husband. Rose has been a victim of racial tension in the presence of her mother-in-law. She is accused of being 'without wood' by her mother, An-mei, because she appears indecisive and too willing to do as others want her to do. With her mother's help, she realises how strong her voice can be. (AO4)

	• Suyuan Woo's story in <i>The Joy Luck Club</i> very much mirrors Amy Tan's mother's story. Amy Tan was born in California in 1952 to immigrant Chinese parents. Tan learned that her mother, prior to moving to America, had been married to an abusive partner and had left behind three daughters. In 1987, Tan travelled with her mother back to China where she was reunited with her daughters • female subservience was a feature common in both Chinese and American cultures of the time: Lindo was forced to live almost as a servant; An-mei's mother was raped by her future husband and had to marry to preserve her honour; men in China were allowed polygamous marriages and to have any number of concubines; the American daughters experience sexism from the older men in the park; Rose is passive in her relationship with Ted, as she accepts a stereotypical role. Tan questions the concepts of respect for tradition and the disrespect of individuals • there is emphasis on equal rights for women and how women become stronger when they learn to speak up for themselves • Chinese culture, traditions and superstition are ingrained in the novel; for example, the burning of the candle at both ends on the wedding night.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
11 <i>The Joy Luck Club</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - Jing-mei Woo is significant as she is the main narrator in the novel. Her narratives serve as a bridge between the two generations: the mothers and daughters. She speaks for both herself and her deceased mother, Suyuan - Jing-mei is significant because she represents those of her generation caught between two cultures. She wants to be accepted as an American and tries to hide her Chinese background. As a result, Jing-mei scorns what she considers to be the strange clothes that all the mothers wear to the Joy Luck Club, describing them as 'funny Chinese dresses with stiff stand-up collars and blooming branches of embroidered silk sewn over their breasts'. She also feels that the Joy Luck Club is a 'shameful Chinese custom, like the secret gathering of the Ku Klux Klan or the tom-tom dances of TV Indians preparing for war' - Jing-mei is significant as she is the victim of her mother's belief in the American promise: with hard work, anything can be achieved. Suyuan believes that her daughter possesses great ability, and she is determined to uncover it. At first, Suyuan tries to get Jing-mei to be a successful child actress but, when this fails, she makes Jing-mei play the piano in the hope that she will be a child prodigy. Jing-mei believes that her mother is harshly critical of her. It is not until later in the novel that Jing-mei comes to realise that her mother's actions were founded on love and wanting the best for her daughter - following the New Year's dinner, Suyuan gives her daughter a gift of a jade pendant, which she calls 'life's importance', and she tells Jing-mei 'This is young jade. It is a very light color now, but if you wear it every day it will become more green'. Suyuan understands that her daughter, just like the pendant, will mature over time. At first, Jing-mei dislikes the pendant and sees it as a Chinese cultural symbol, but after her mother's death she values it as a symbol of love. The pendant is also a symbol of understanding, which is significant because Jing-mei learns to appreciate her mother's words of wisdom - after her mother's death, Jing-mei decides to keep her silk Chinese dresses. This is significant because it symbolises Jing-mei's gradual acceptance of her Chinese heritage - Jing-mei is also significant because she successfully bridges the two countries, two generations and two cultures. When she travels to Shanghai with her father to meet her half-sisters, her greatest fear is that she will be seen as an American and she will fail to see any Chinese elements within herself. However, as she enters Shenzhen, she feels she is becoming Chinese. Through her meeting with her half-sisters, Jing-mei embraces her heritage and finally feels as though she belongs - ultimately, Jing-mei is significant because what she learns about her own mother's struggles leads the mothers to reveal their own difficulties and complex relationships with their daughters.

(AO4)

- Amy Tan was inspired to write *The Joy Luck Club* after listening to her own mother's stories about her life in China; the novel is set in San Francisco in the 1980s and the stories span a range of decades from the 1920s. Jing-mei's story mirrors Amy Tan's own experiences
- Suyuan expects Jing-mei to obey her elders and learn by obedience, observation and imitation
- during and after the Second World War, immigration restrictions were eased as the United States allied with China against Japanese expansionism. Jing-mei's life is influenced by her exposure to American culture and her mother's Chinese heritage
- the Chinese culture is high-context: the bonds among people are very strong, within the family unit, particularly to Suyuan. Ways of behaving are important and not observing cultural traditions brings shame on the entire family. This contrasts with the low-context culture of America, epitomised through Jing-mei: change is rapid and easy, and bonds between people are looser.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
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Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
12 <i>Things Fall Apart</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to agree or disagree, wholly or in part, with the view that Nwoye is the character readers are likely to have most sympathy for. Candidates may choose another character, for example Ikemefuna, Okonkwo and Ekwefi, but any choice is valid. Responses should be assessed based on the arguments presented • Nwoye is Okonkwo's eldest son by his first wife and is 12 years old when the story begins. Nwoye is a gentle character who is badly treated by his father. He is regularly beaten and scolded by his father because he thinks that Nwoye is too lazy • sympathy is felt for Nwoye because he is not understood by his father. Okonkwo fears that Nwoye is not as manly as he wants him to be and that he will be weak, too sensitive and feminine, like Okonkwo's father, Unoka • Nwoye fears the anger of his powerful and demanding father and finds it difficult to cope in his shadow. For example, Nwoye helps Okonkwo to prepare the seed yams, but he is constantly criticised by his father • Nwoye is horrified when his father slays Ikemefuna and, in defiance, Nwoye converts to Christianity, taking the name Isaac. When Okonkwo learns that his son has joined the missionaries, he refuses to speak to him, disowning him. He believes that his son is lost and 'not worth fighting for'. Sympathy is likely to be felt for the irreparable breakdown in the relationship between father and son • however, candidates might argue that readers are likely to have the most sympathy for Ikemefuna. He is an innocent character who suffers because of other people's actions. Ikemefuna is kind-hearted and portrayed as a caring character, particularly when he befriends Nwoye. At the age of 14, Ikemefuna has been sent as a peace offering by the people of Mbanta to Umuofia and, despite being favoured by Okonkwo, is violently murdered by him three years later, on the orders of the Oracle • alternatively, candidates could argue that Okonkwo is in fact the character readers are likely to have the most sympathy for. Despite his desire to keep the clan strong and to prove himself a worthy warrior, he resorts to the ultimate act of weakness, according to tribal beliefs, by taking his own life. The tragic fall of the protagonist, Okonkwo, and his despair are understood by the reader as things fall apart around him • candidates might choose to argue that Ekwefi, Okonkwo's second wife and mother of Ezinma, is the character readers are likely to have the most sympathy for. She has left her first husband to begin a life with Okonkwo, but she is beaten by him when she takes some banana leaves from his plant. Sympathy is also felt for her because she has had a number of children, but all have died in their infancy, except for her only surviving daughter, Ezinma. (AO4)

	• Nwoye challenges all that is important to his father. The novel is set in a patriarchal society, where men were often feared, and it explores the importance of kinship, extended families and their roles and responsibilities • in the novel, ceremonies and rituals are important in every aspect of the villagers' lives: eating, drinking, marriage, war, religion. Umuofia's 'Priests and medicine men were feared' by other tribes. Nwoye's rejection of his culture, and conversion to Christianity, brings shame to Okonkwo • traditional Nigerian society is contrasted with impending colonial and Christian influences; changes in the nature of Igbo (Ibo in the novel) society and its traditions and culture are feared by Okonkwo, but welcomed by Nwoye • women played an important and essential role in Igbo family life, despite their generally subservient position at the time. A woman's importance was determined by how many children she bore and how many of them were male.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
13 Things Fall Apart	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the importance of gaining and maintaining a good reputation is evident throughout the novel. It is, at least in part, Okonkwo's determination to overcome the stigma of his father's legacy that leads to his becoming a wealthy, successful man with three wives - a good reputation is vitally important to Okonkwo. Even as a young man, Okonkwo has become a successful warrior and a wealthy farmer. He has won two titles for his 'prowess in two inter-tribal wars' and has 'two barns full of yams' - Okonkwo is driven by his fear of getting a reputation like his father, Unoka, who, unlike other warrior friends, had no titles. Unoka was viewed as a weak man by the Igbo (Ibo in the novel) tribe - Unoka was a laughingstock of the village and, when Okonkwo was a child, one of his playmates called Unoka 'agbala', suggesting that he was womanly. In order to counteract this, Okonkwo has been determined to gain a good reputation for himself - in Igbo society, men have a number of wives; the more wives and children a man has is an important way of showing his status. Okonkwo provides for his three wives, making his wealth visible to others; his <i>obi</i> (hut) is behind a gate in the red wall, and his three wives each have their own hut behind it - ankle bracelets are an important symbol in Igbo society as they signify the number of titles men have gained. Okonkwo is proud to display his, which he has earned through hard work. In contrast, his father did not have any - the 'Oracle of the Hills and Caves' has a formidable reputation and is respected by members of the tribe, who do as the Oracle commands. This is important in the novel because it contributes to the drama. When it is ordered that Ikemefuna is taken and killed, the Oracle's decision is final and goes unquestioned - after his accidentally killing Ezeudu's son, Okonkwo's seven-year exile is a hard punishment for him to bear as not only must he leave his village, but his reputation is in tatters - the growing acceptance and positive reputation of the British Christians threaten all that is sacred to Okonkwo as the number of converts grow. Okonkwo fears for the loss of Igbo identity, culture and traditions. The members of the colonial government have a fearful reputation as they whip and humiliate Okonkwo and other prisoners - it is Okonkwo's fear of weakness and failure, resulting in his losing his good reputation, that leads to his eventual fall. In Igbo culture, his name reflects his personality as it can imply male pride and stubbornness. At the end of the novel, it could be argued that Okonkwo's weaknesses make him little different from his father - Unoka died in disgrace and shame, leaving the family in debt. He suffered from a swelling of the stomach and limbs and was left to die in the Evil Forest.

It is, perhaps, ironic that, although Okonkwo is determined not to be like his father, he too dies a shameful death when he takes his own life after he realises that he cannot save the village from the colonists.

(AO4)

- the novel explores the customs, cultures and beliefs of the Igbo people. The shame Okonkwo feels for his father leads him to try to be the polar opposite. Okonkwo becomes wealthy and has a number of ankle bracelets to demonstrate publicly his titles. Like other important men in his village, his high status is demonstrated by the number of wives and how many children he has
- the reputation and role of women vary depending on their status in the family: the food prepared by Okonkwo's wives is eaten by him in order of their seniority; at Nwakibie's *obi*, 'the others could not drink' before the arrival of his first wife
- in Igbo society, reputation is gained through being traditional and by showing respect and obedience to the gods. Umuofia's 'Priests and medicine men were feared' by other tribes
- the cultural customs and traditions of Igbo society are challenged by the arrival of Christianity and colonialism.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
14 <i>Klara and the Sun</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the Sun is of vital significance in the novel, as indicated by its inclusion in the title. In particular, as a solar-powered Artificial Friend (AF), Klara depends on the Sun to function. She also relies on its support and protection, and she has complete faith in its powers. However, the human characters in the novel do not appear to place as much value on its significance - Klara considers the Sun to be human-like, and she refers to the Sun as 'he'. At the start of the novel, when Klara and Rosa watch the Sun out of the window, Klara describes how they 'would see the Sun on his journey' - when Rosa and Klara are new in the store, Boy AF Rex provides reassurance to them by telling them that the Sun would be able to reach them wherever they are: 'If you're worried, you can just touch it and get strong again'. Throughout the novel, the Sun is considered a vital source of comfort - without the Sun, Klara would not be able to function. When she is away from the window in the store, Klara describes how she gets 'weaker and weaker'. The Sun is also significant for Klara because she believes it to be a source of nourishment, with healing powers. When the Beggar Man stops moving, and Klara believes him to be dead, he appears to be resurrected the next morning when the Sun rises - the Sun is a source of companionship for Klara throughout the novel. She develops rituals about how to communicate with the Sun, and she talks to the Sun directly - Klara turns to the Sun for help in times of need. Having returned from the city with Klara and her parents, Josie's health begins to deteriorate. When Rick becomes particularly concerned about Josie, Klara reassures him that there is still 'reason to hope'. Determined to do what she can to help Josie, Klara, with Rick's help, travels to Mr McBain's barn where she pleads with the Sun to heal Josie. This is a place where Klara feels that she is able to communicate, and connect, with the Sun - Melania Housekeeper goes to shut out the Sun from the room where Josie is ill in bed. However, Klara is adamant that Melania Housekeeper should let the Sun in, believing in its healing powers: 'We must let the Sun do his best!' The other characters in the room go along with Klara's demands, perhaps as a sign of their desperation to try anything to help Josie recover - later, Josie recovers and Klara is certain that 'The Sun's nourishment proved as effective for Josie as it had for Beggar Man'. The faith Klara has in the Sun's healing effect on Josie is unfounded, but, nevertheless, the Sun could be said to represent hope - at the end of the novel, when Manager visits the yard and sees Klara, it is clear that Klara's faith in the Sun is unwavering. Klara concludes the

	conversation by saying 'I must report to you ... The Sun was very kind to me. He was always kind to me from the start' • it is significant that none of the human characters in the novel truly appreciate the Sun or think about its value in the world. This could, perhaps, represent how out of touch humans have become with the world around them. (AO4) • set at a time in the not-too-distant future, and against the backdrop of current increasing capabilities of technology, the novel considers the possibilities and limitations of using artificial intelligence. One of Klara's limitations is that she is powered by solar energy, which is particularly problematic when she stays inside • in contrast, as the novel is told from Klara's perspective, and she is able to express her thoughts, the future possibilities of artificial intelligence are made clear • the novel could be considered an exploration of the idea that having any kind of faith, such as Klara's belief in the Sun and its healing powers, is based on a misunderstanding • nevertheless, the novel offers an important message about the importance of faith as a way of providing hope. Indeed, in different cultures, the Sun is considered a sign of hope and new beginnings.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
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Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
15 <i>Klara and the Sun</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Melania Housekeeper, who lives with the Mother, Josie and, later, Klara too, runs the household. She is initially presented as rather abrupt and abrasive • when Melania Housekeeper is first introduced in the novel, she is presented as someone very much in control of the home. Klara reflects how she ‘would constantly move items around’ in the kitchen, such as how Melania Housekeeper ‘altered the position of her food blender four times within as many minutes’ • initially, Klara thinks Melania Housekeeper might support her with her role as an Artificial Friend (AF), in a similar manner to Manager. However, in her initial interactions with Klara, Melania Housekeeper is presented as standoffish. She is described as having shouted at Klara: ‘Quit follow me AF get lost!’ • there are signs that Melania Housekeeper is concerned that Klara might make her position as housekeeper redundant, with Klara reflecting how Melania Housekeeper seemed ‘opposed from the start’ to her presence. Klara remembers how Melania Housekeeper would make her stand by the refrigerator and Klara would only be allowed to join Josie and the Mother after continual protests from Josie • Melania Housekeeper is presented as particularly attentive to the needs of the Mother and Josie. Klara describes how she would be ‘hovering nearby ready to refill’ coffee • the Mother trusts Melania Housekeeper with the care of her daughter. Klara and Josie must tell her when they want to go outside, and Melania Housekeeper insists on accompanying them, even linking arms with Josie. When Josie asks Melania Housekeeper if she can introduce Rick to Klara, she reluctantly agrees but she decides when the interaction must conclude: ‘Okay enough now!’ • despite Melania Housekeeper’s hard demeanour, there are signs that she takes some responsibility for Klara as well as Josie. For example, when preparing to travel to Morgan Falls, she says to Klara ‘AF. Strap on belt. Or you get damaged’ • Melania Housekeeper is presented as having a close relationship with Josie. When Josie is bedridden and Melania Housekeeper is tasked with sitting with her, she pays constant attention to Josie • the relationship between Melania Housekeeper and Klara is presented as one that develops over time. When Rick visits Josie, she trusts Klara to keep an eye on the pair, telling her ‘You stay in there. Make sure no hanky-panky’. Later, when the Mother does not let Melania Housekeeper go into the city with Josie, she tells Klara to stay close to Josie • towards the end of the novel, the reader learns that Melania Housekeeper has moved to Indiana, and then California. It is clear that Klara grew fond of her, as she comments ‘I got kind of used to her. I hope she’s okay’.

(AO4)

- in this dystopian novel, AFs are a type of artificial intelligence created with the purpose of accompanying children until they grow up, akin to a nanny in robot form. It is, therefore, possibly understandable that Melania Housekeeper might be concerned that Klara could replace her in the household
- the novel is told from Klara's perspective. As a particularly observant AF, she is able to provide precise detail about how Melania Housekeeper behaves. However, Klara lacks the understanding of human emotions and, therefore, does not fully appreciate why Melania Housekeeper might be put out by her presence
- set in an unnamed American city in the not-too-distant future, parts of the novel reflect life as it is today for some people, with Melania Housekeeper's needing to move in order to find work
- the novel explores the relationship between humans and artificial intelligence, and suggests that there will need to be learning on both sides to improve understanding of how each other works.

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Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
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Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
16 Western Lane	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • there are several important settings featured in the novel. Much of the action takes place either at the family home or at Western Lane, where the girls play squash • as a result of Pa's desire for his daughters to have something to occupy themselves with after the loss of their mother, they spend 'two, three, four hours a day' practising squash at Western Lane • Western Lane is a particularly important setting for Gopi. This is where she develops her prowess as a squash player, but it is also where she meets Ged. From the first time she meets him, it is clear that she develops feelings for him. When Gopi is not at the squash club, she thinks about him, wondering if he would still be there late into the night • as the narrator, Gopi shifts between describing the atmosphere of the family home when Ma was alive to what life is like there following her death. This serves to highlight the drastic impact of Ma's loss on the family and the home • the three girls often spend time at the fort, a derelict building next to a hill, when they are not at school or practising squash. There are indications that the girls see this as a place of safety: 'No one spat on us from a height or told us to go home' • Pa understands the fact that his daughters are growing up, and he is sensitive towards the needs of his girls. He recognises the importance of the girls having their own space and he rarely goes into their bedrooms. When Pa does go into Mona's bedroom one day when she is ill, the description could be seen to symbolise how the girls are transitioning from girls to young women: 'He sat on the child's stool in front of the dressing table' • the girls attend Gujarati school but they struggle there. They find the language difficult to learn and they do not have a close relationship with their peers. There are signs that the girls continue to attend out of respect for their mother. Gopi admits how, when Ma was gone, she'd paid more attention there • the turning point of the novel takes place at Western Lane when Gopi injures her father with a hard-hit ball while playing. This is an important part of the novel, as it ultimately results in Gopi's going to live with Aunt Ranjan and Uncle Pavan in Edinburgh • previously, following the death of Ma, the family has visited Aunt Ranjan and Uncle Pavan at their home in Edinburgh. This is an important setting because it is here that Aunt Ranjan advises Pa to focus the girls' attention on playing squash, to provide the 'wild' girls with 'exercise and discipline' • it is also on this visit to the home of Aunt Ranjan and Uncle Pavan that Aunt Ranjan tells Pa that she thinks that it is in the best interests of him and the

three girls for her and Uncle Pavan to take one of them in. She tells Pa 'You cannot look after three ... Three is too many'

- when Gopi arrives to live in Edinburgh, Uncle Pavan does everything he can to make sure she feels at home. He gives her a radio to listen to whenever she wants to, and he shows her around the house. When Gopi tells him that she knows the house, he replies 'It's different now ... It's your home'
- it is also here that Aunt Ranjan initially refuses to let Gopi enter the squash tournament: 'it is not right for a girl'. It is only thanks to Uncle Pavan's persistence with his wife that Gopi is eventually allowed to attend
- the novel ends with Gopi winning the tournament in a village outside Durham. This is an important setting because it is here that Gopi shows her determination to overcome challenges, and she is clearly emotional at the sense of personal achievement
- other settings candidates might consider include the fair and Maqsud's cousin's house. All settings, and their importance, considered should be rewarded for the points presented.

(AO4)

- the novel begins a few days after the funeral of Ma. Pa and his three daughters go to stay with Aunt Ranjan and Uncle Pavan at their home in Edinburgh and they share a meal as a family. This traditionally marks the end of the Jain formal mourning period following a family member's death
- as a British Gujarati family, the girls speak English for the most part, but they are expected to attend Gujarati school, which is partly in order to maintain this side of their identity as they grow up
- in Jainism, it is thought that a disciplined life can help to eliminate bad karma. The girls attend Western Lane to focus their minds, particularly after their mother's passing
- the girls tend to avoid spending time in the bar at Western Lane. This could be because, in Jainism, no consumption of alcohol is permitted. However, Mona's rebellious nature is evident when Gopi sees her pouring whisky into her drink at the fair.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
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Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
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Question number	Indicative content
17 Western Lane	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Pa is shown to want the best for his daughters throughout the novel. For example, it is his desire for his daughters to be successful in life that results in his difficult decision for Gopi to go to live with Aunt Ranjan and Uncle Pavan in Edinburgh • although Pa struggles to communicate with his daughters, he recognises that they are at an important stage in their lives, which is why he tells them 'I want you to become interested in something you can do your whole life'. He encourages them to play squash, clearly wanting his daughters to have something to occupy themselves with after the loss of their mother • there are parallels between Pa's intentions in wanting his daughters to play squash and the story he tells of Jahangir Khan, the winner of the squash World Open Championship. Jahangir's brother died when Jahangir was just fifteen, following which his cousin, Rahat, trained him to be the best player he could be, resulting in an unbeaten streak of 555 matches. Later, Pa admits to his daughters 'You have to address yourself to something' • initially, Pa joins in with his daughters playing squash. However, as time progresses, he is shown to observe the girls from the other side of the glass. It is clear that Pa wants his daughters to become independent and have the desire to improve for themselves • Pa shows an understanding of the fact that his daughters are growing up, and he is sensitive towards the needs of his girls, such as the way he rarely goes into their bedrooms so that they have their own space. When Pa does go into Mona's bedroom one day to check on Mona when she is ill, he is respectful of her need, as a young woman, for space: 'He sat on the child's stool in front of the dressing table' • Pa becomes close to Ged's mother, Linda. However, this relationship does not develop. It could be argued that this is because Pa does not want to upset his daughters • as Gopi recovers from her illness, Pa stays up late with her. Although she is unable to attend Western Lane, he wants to ensure that she is ready to return, so they spend time watching videos of squash • following Ma's death, Pa keeps himself busy with work all the time, which is, at least in part, in an effort to provide for his daughters. However, it becomes clear that he is unable to cope with life following the death of his wife, and he begins to turn down work with the excuse that he is too busy. It is his ability to recognise that he is not coping, in addition to his wanting the best for his daughters, that results in his decision for Gopi to go to live with Aunt Ranjan and Uncle Pavan in Edinburgh • towards the end of the novel, Pa travels to the village in the countryside near Durham to watch Gopi take part in the squash tournament. He shows how nervous he is for his daughter, clearly wanting the best for her, when he is

unable to watch her play, and he has to leave the hall. Although Pa struggles to communicate with his daughters, his mere presence at the tournament is indicative of his desire to see his daughters succeed in life.

(AO4)

- in Jain families, there is an underlying expectation that fathers will guide family members in their spiritual and personal growth
- Pa's inability to express his emotions could be deemed to conform to the view of masculinity in the 1980s. Therefore, it is mostly through his actions that the reader understands how he is a father who wants the best for his daughters
- there is a strong emphasis in Jainism on being peaceful and not being argumentative. It could, therefore, be argued that Pa's passive nature is his modelling to his daughters how to adhere to Jain values
- the novel explores the role of the father in the family home in Britain in the 1980s; it would generally have been expected for a father to provide for his family. This is one reason, perhaps, why Pa throws himself into work following Ma's passing.

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